

Absolutely — **youth** is a strong one because it has several genuine shifts: **life stage**, **young people collectively**, **the period of someone's younger life**, **youthful qualities**, and **institutional/sport compounds**. I'll keep the same depth and use the Golden Manual approach: exhaustive search, but merge contexts that share the same underlying meaning rather than over-splitting.

Word family: **youth / youths / youthful / youthfully / youthfulness**

Base word: youth

Plural: youths

Related adjective: youthful

Related adverb: youthfully

Related noun: youthfulness

Useful compounds / extensions: youth development, youth sport, youth athlete, youth team, youth club, youth centre, youth worker, youth work, youth programme, youth services, youth culture, youth market, youth unemployment, youth crime, youth justice, youth outreach, youth engagement, youth leadership

Part of speech: noun / adjective-like attributive use

Your sentence

> “With my athletic background, practical knowledge of competition, and commitment to **youth development**, I believe I am well suited to support the Foundation's mission.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **youth** refers to **young people**, especially children, teenagers, and young adults who are still developing.

In **youth development**, the phrase means helping young people grow in areas such as:

- * skills
- * confidence
- * education
- * health
- * character
- * social development
- * sporting ability

繁體中文：

青少年 / 年輕人的成長與發展

中文翻譯：

> 「憑藉我的運動背景、比賽實務知識，以及對**青少年發展**的投入，我相信自己很適合支持基金會的使命。」

****youth development = 透過教育、訓練、支援和機會，促進青少年在能力、身心及社會方面的成長****

1. youth — the period of life when someone is young — 青年時期；青春期

The central noun meaning is the period between childhood and adulthood.

Practice 1

> “He spent much of his ****youth**** training as an athlete.”

「他的****青年時期****大部分時間都在接受運動訓練。」

Practice 2

> “She developed a love of sport in her ****youth****.”

「她在****年輕時****培養了對運動的熱愛。」

****youth = 一個人從童年逐步進入成年之前或成年初期的年輕生命階段****

This is usually ****uncountable****.

2. youth — young people collectively — 青少年；年輕人

This is the meaning behind your phrase ****youth development****.

Practice 3 — Passage sense

> “The Foundation is committed to ****youth**** development.”

「基金會致力於****青少年****發展。」

Practice 4

> “The programme provides opportunities for local ****youth****.”

「這項計劃為本地****青少年****提供機會。」

Practice 5

> “Sport can play an important role in supporting ****youth****.”

「運動可以在支援**青少年**方面發揮重要作用。」

youth = 被視為一個整體的青少年 / 年輕人群體

Grammar note

In this collective sense, **youth** is often uncountable:

- > youth development
- > youth services
- > youth unemployment

not usually:

> youths development ❌

3. a youth — one young person — 一名青年；一名年輕人

Youth can also be countable.

Practice 6

> “A **youth** was waiting outside the sports centre.”

「一名**青年**正在體育中心外等候。」

Practice 7

> “The police spoke to two **youths**.”

「警方與兩名**青年**交談。」

a youth = 一名年輕人，通常指青少年或年輕男性，但實際指涉要看語境

Register note

This use can sound:

- * formal
- * journalistic
- * legal
- * police-report-like

In everyday conversation, **young person** is often more natural.

4. youths — several young people — 多名青年

The plural **youths** refers to individual young people.

Practice 8

> “Several **youths** joined the training programme.”

「幾名**青年**參加了訓練計劃。」

Practice 9

> “The centre offers evening activities for local **youths**.”

「該中心為本地**青少年**提供晚間活動。」

youths = 多名個別年輕人

Important distinction

youth

= young people collectively

youths

= several individual young people

5. youth — early stage or beginning of something — 初期；早期階段

Figuratively, **youth** can describe the early stage of an organisation, movement, field, or development.

Practice 10

> “The sport was still in its **youth** at that time.”

「當時這項運動仍處於**發展初期**。」

Practice 11

> “The technology is still in its **youth**.”

「這項科技仍處於**早期發展階段**。」

****youth = 某件事物尚處於剛起步、發展尚未成熟的早期階段****

This is less common than the human meanings, but it is a genuine figurative extension.

6. youth — qualities associated with being young — 青春；年輕活力

****Youth**** can also refer abstractly to qualities associated with young age.

Practice 12

> “The campaign celebrated energy and ****youth****.”

「這項宣傳頌揚活力與****青春氣息****。」

Practice 13

> “The design combines tradition with a sense of ****youth****.”

「這個設計把傳統與****年輕活力****結合起來。」

****youth = 與年輕人相關的活力、新鮮感、朝氣或青春感****

This is more abstract and often stylistic.

7. youthful — looking or behaving young — 年輕的；青春的

The main adjective.

Practice 14

> “He still has a very ****youthful**** appearance.”

「他的外表仍然非常****年輕****。」

Practice 15

> “She brings a ****youthful**** energy to the team.”

「她為團隊帶來一種****年輕、有朝氣的活力****。」

****youthful = 外表、行為、精神或氣質呈現出年輕人的特徵****

8. youthful — energetic/fresh rather than literally young — 朝氣蓬勃的；充滿青春感的

This is an important figurative branch.

Practice 16

> “The brand wants a more ****youthful**** image.”

「品牌希望建立一個更****年輕、有活力的形象****。」

Practice 17

> “The redesign gives the website a more youthful feel.”

「重新設計令網站更有****青春活力的感覺****。」

****youthful = 具有年輕、活潑、新鮮或有朝氣的特質，不一定表示實際年齡很小****

9. youthfulness — youthful quality — 青春感；年輕氣息

Practice 18

> “Her ****youthfulness**** gave the campaign a fresh energy.”

「她的****青春活力****為宣傳活動帶來新鮮感。」

Practice 19

> “The design aims to preserve a sense of youthfulness.”

「這個設計希望保留一種****年輕活力的感覺****。」

****youthfulness = 外表、行為或風格中呈現出的年輕感、活力或朝氣****

10. youth development — 青少年發展

This is the exact compound in your passage.

Practice 20

> “The coach has a strong interest in **youth development**.”

「這名教練非常重視**青少年發展**。」

Practice 21

> “Sport can support long-term youth development.”

「運動可以促進長期的**青少年成長與發展**。」

youth development = 透過教育、訓練、支援和機會，促進青少年能力、品格、健康及社會發展的過程

11. youth sport — 青少年體育

Sport organised for children, teenagers, or young people.

Practice 22

> “She has worked in **youth sport** for ten years.”

「她從事**青少年體育**工作已有十年。」

Practice 23

> “Good coaching is essential in youth sport.”

「良好的教練指導對**青少年體育**非常重要。」

youth sport = 為青少年而設的體育活動、訓練及競賽體系

12. youth athlete — 青少年運動員

Practice 24

> “A **youth athlete** needs appropriate training and recovery.”

「**青少年運動員**需要合適的訓練和恢復安排。」

Practice 25

> “The programme supports talented youth athletes.”

「這項計劃支援有潛質的**青少年運動員**。」

13. youth team — 青年隊；青少年隊伍

Practice 26

> “He began coaching the club’s **youth team**.”

「他開始執教俱樂部的**青年隊**。」

Practice 27

> “Several players progressed from the youth team to the senior squad.”

「幾名球員由**青年隊**晉升到成年隊。」

youth team = 主要由青少年或年輕運動員組成的隊伍

14. youth club — 青年會；青少年活動中心

Practice 28

> “The local **youth club** runs sports activities every weekend.”

「本地**青年會 / 青少年活動中心**每個週末都有體育活動。」

Practice 29

> “She volunteered at a youth club.”

「她在一間**青年中心**做義工。」

15. youth centre / youth center — 青年中心

Practice 30

> “The new **youth centre** includes a sports hall.”

「新的**青年中心**設有體育館。」

Practice 31

> “The youth centre offers mentoring and training.”

「**青年中心**提供導師支援和訓練。」

16. youth work — 青年工作

A professional/community field focused on supporting young people.

Practice 32

> “He has experience in **youth work**.”

「他具有**青年工作**經驗。」

Practice 33

> “Youth work often combines education, mentoring and community support.”

「**青年工作**通常結合教育、導師支援和社區服務。」

youth work = 透過社區、教育、輔導及活動支援青少年發展的專業 / 社會工作

17. youth worker — 青年工作者

Practice 34

> “The **youth worker** helped students plan their next steps.”

「**青年工作者**協助學生規劃下一步。」

Practice 35

> “Youth workers often support vulnerable young people.”

「**青年工作者**經常支援有需要的年輕人。」

****youth worker = 專門支援青少年成長、教育、社交或生活需要的人員****

18. youth programme / youth program — 青少年計劃

Practice 36

> “The Foundation launched a new ****youth programme****.”

「基金會推出了一項新的****青少年計劃****。」

Practice 37

> “The youth programme combines sport and mentoring.”

「這項****青少年計劃****結合運動和導師支援。」

19. youth services — 青少年服務

Practice 38

> “The council provides ****youth services**** across the district.”

「議會在整個地區提供****青少年服務****。」

Practice 39

> “Funding for youth services has increased.”

「****青少年服務****的撥款增加了。」

****youth services = 為青少年提供教育、健康、就業、輔導、活動等支援的公共 / 社區服務****

20. youth outreach — 青少年外展

Directly relevant to your source passage’s idea of school outreach.

Practice 40

> “The organisation expanded its ****youth outreach**** work.”

「該機構擴展了**青少年外展工作**。」

Practice 41

> “Youth outreach helps identify promising athletes.”

「**青少年外展工作**有助發掘有潛質的運動員。」

youth outreach = 主動接觸社區或學校中的青少年，向他們提供資訊、活動、支援或機會

21. youth engagement — 青少年參與

Practice 42

> “The programme aims to increase **youth engagement** in sport.”

「這項計劃旨在提高青少年對體育活動的**參與度**。」

Practice 43

> “Youth engagement is central to the project.”

「**青少年參與**是這個項目的核心。」

youth engagement = 鼓勵青少年主動參與活動、決策、社區或組織的程度 / 過程

22. youth leadership — 青年領導力；青少年領袖培育

Practice 44

> “The camp focuses on **youth leadership**.”

「這個營隊著重培養**青年領導力**。」

Practice 45

> “Youth leadership programmes help young people build confidence.”

「**青年領袖培育計劃**幫助年輕人建立自信。」

23. youth culture — 青年文化

Practice 46

> “Music has always played an important role in **youth culture**.”

「音樂一直在**青年文化**中扮演重要角色。」

Practice 47

> “The brand tried to connect with youth culture.”

「品牌嘗試與**青年文化**建立連結。」

youth culture = 青少年 / 年輕人共享的流行文化、價值觀、時尚、音樂及生活方式

24. youth market — 青年市場

In business/marketing:

Practice 48

> “The company is targeting the **youth market**.”

「公司正以**青年消費市場**為目標。」

Practice 49

> “The product became popular in the youth market.”

「這件產品在**年輕消費者市場**中變得流行。」

youth market = 以青少年或年輕消費者為主要對象的市場

25. youth unemployment — 青年失業

Practice 50

> “The government introduced measures to reduce **youth unemployment**.”

「政府推出措施降低**青年失業率**。」

Practice 51

> “Youth unemployment remains a serious economic issue.”

「**青年失業**仍是一個嚴重的經濟問題。」

youth unemployment = 青年人口中沒有工作而正在尋找工作的情況 / 比例

26. youth crime — 青少年犯罪

Practice 52

> “The programme aims to reduce **youth crime**.”

「這項計劃旨在減少**青少年犯罪**。」

Practice 53

> “Community sport can help address youth crime.”

「社區體育可以幫助處理**青少年犯罪問題**。」

27. youth justice — 青少年司法；少年司法

Practice 54

> “She works in the **youth justice** system.”

「她在**青少年司法 / 少年司法制度**中工作。」

Practice 55

> “Youth justice focuses on offences committed by young people.”

「**青少年司法**主要處理年輕人所犯的罪行。」

youth justice = 專門處理青少年違法行為、處分、復康及支援的司法體系

28. youth hostel — 青年旅舍

A common lexicalized compound.

Practice 56

> “We stayed in a **youth hostel** near the station.”

「我們住在車站附近的一間**青年旅舍**。」

Practice 57

> “Youth hostels usually provide relatively affordable accommodation.”

「**青年旅舍**通常提供價格較相宜的住宿。」

youth hostel = 傳統上以年輕旅客為主要對象、價格較相宜的住宿設施

This is lexicalized; modern youth hostels may also accept older travellers.

Important distinctions

youth vs young people

youth

can sound:

- * formal
- * institutional
- * sociological
- * policy-related
- * collective

young people

is more ordinary and conversational.

> “programmes for youth”

formal/institutional

> “programmes for young people”

more everyday.

youth vs teenager

youth

broader and less precise in age.

teenager

specifically someone aged 13–19.

A **youth programme** may include people who are not teenagers, depending on the organisation.

youth vs adolescent

adolescent

more technical/medical/psychological and refers to the developmental stage between childhood and adulthood.

youth

broader social/general term.

youth vs child

child

usually refers to someone younger.

youth

usually suggests an older child, teenager, or young adult.

Exact boundaries vary by context and institution.

youth vs young adult

young adult

explicitly indicates adulthood, though relatively young.

youth

can include both minors and young adults depending on context.

youth vs juvenile

juvenile

often appears in:

- * law
- * policing
- * biology
- * formal classification

and may sound more institutional or legal.

youth

is generally broader and less legalistic.

youthful vs young

young

describes actual age:

> “a young coach”

youthful

describes qualities associated with youth:

> “a youthful coach”

The second may describe someone who is not actually young but looks or acts young.

This is a very important distinction.

youthful vs immature

youthful

usually positive or neutral:

- * energetic
- * fresh
- * lively

immature

usually negative:

- * lacking maturity
- * behaving childishly
- * not fully developed

Someone can be **youthful** without being **immature**.

Important countability note

youth = life stage

uncountable:

> “in his youth”

youth = young people collectively

usually uncountable:

> “services for youth”

a youth

countable:

> “a youth entered the building”

youths

plural:

> “three youths were waiting outside”

This shift is one of the strongest learner points in the family.

Family-extension sweep

After the full ordinary, collective, institutional, social, legal, sporting, compound, countability, and second-pass audit, the useful modern family includes:

- * **youth — life stage** = 青年時期
- * **youth — young people collectively** = 青少年 / 青年人群
- * **a youth** = 一名青年
- * **youths** = 多名青年
- * **youth — early stage figurative** = 初期 / 早期階段
- * **youth — youthful qualities** = 青春 / 朝氣
- * **youthful** = 年輕的 / 有青春活力的
- * **youthfulness** = 青春感 / 年輕氣息
- * **youth development** = 青少年發展
- * **youth sport** = 青少年體育
- * **youth athlete** = 青少年運動員
- * **youth team** = 青年隊
- * **youth club** = 青年會 / 青少年中心
- * **youth centre** = 青年中心
- * **youth work** = 青年工作
- * **youth worker** = 青年工作者
- * **youth programme** = 青少年計劃
- * **youth services** = 青少年服務
- * **youth outreach** = 青少年外展
- * **youth engagement** = 青少年參與
- * **youth leadership** = 青年領導力 / 領袖培育
- * **youth culture** = 青年文化
- * **youth market** = 青年市場
- * **youth unemployment** = 青年失業
- * **youth crime** = 青少年犯罪
- * **youth justice** = 青少年司法
- * **youth hostel** = 青年旅舍

I would stop there; beyond this point we mainly get transparent institutional compounds rather than new learner-relevant senses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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youth — life stage	一個人從童年逐步進入成年前後的年輕生命階段
youth — young people collectively	被視為一個整體的青少年 / 年輕人群體
a youth	一名年輕人，常見於較正式、新聞或法律語境
youths	多名個別青年 / 年輕人
youth — early stage figurative	某件事物尚未成熟、仍處於剛起步的發展初期
youth — youthful qualities	與年輕相關的朝氣、活力、新鮮感或青春感
youthful	外表、行為、精神或風格具有年輕、活潑、有朝氣特徵的
youthfulness	外表、行為或風格中呈現出的青春感和年輕活力
youth development	透過教育、訓練和支援促進青少年能力、品格、健康及社會成長的過程
youth sport	為青少年而設的體育活動、訓練及競賽
youth athlete	正處於青少年年齡階段的運動員
youth team	主要由青少年或年輕運動員組成的隊伍
youth work	透過社區、教育、輔導和活動支援青少年發展的專業工作
youth worker	專門支援青少年成長、教育或生活需要的人員
youth outreach	主動接觸青少年並提供資訊、活動、支援或發展機會的工作
youth engagement	青少年主動參與活動、組織、社區或決策的程度 / 過程
youth culture	年輕人共享的流行文化、價值觀、時尚及生活方式
youth market	以青少年或年輕消費者為主要對象的市場
youth unemployment	青年人口中沒有工作而正在尋找工作的情況 / 比例
youth justice	專門處理青少年違法、處分、復康和支援的司法體系
youth hostel	傳統上以年輕旅客為主要對象的較相宜住宿設施

For your original sentence

> “...commitment to **youth development**...”

The exact meaning is:

youth = 青少年 / 年輕人群體

and:

youth development = 透過訓練、教育、支援、指導和機會，促進青少年在能力、身心、品格和社會方面的成長

So the most natural Traditional Chinese is:

> **「青少年發展」**

This is the **collective young-people sense**, not **youth = someone's younger years**, **a youth = one young person**, or the figurative “early stage” sense.